

A Choice That Has a Cost: A Signal

有代价的选择：一个信号

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

They had published every exemption and still lost the room; now the only question left was what each of them would choose. The tenth arc began in a **museum** of **urban** history, where the **choice** of a career seemed to require an **assessment** that nobody had written. “A **birth** in a village and a degree in the city do not produce the same **consciousness**,” the director said. “You have a **steady** record and a **supreme** reputation, and now you must decide what it is for.”

The **dilemma** was **polite** and **fierce** at once. “I **appreciate** the offer,” Lin said, “but an **elegant** title is not the same as **integrity**.” A **prospective** employer had sent a **memo** and a **memorandum** about the **modernization** of the plant; a second letter mentioned its **modernisation** in the same breath, and a third asked about **neutrality** in a dispute the plant had already lost.

The **wildlife** survey was the **reminder** of what the group actually owned: a **decent** dataset, a **doubtful** forecast, and a **dying** weather station. “A **reversal** of the verdict would require a **decisive** report,” Maya wrote. “We can **imitate** a **respectable** process and we cannot fake the **perseverance** behind it.”

The **puzzle** of the second week was the **acidity** of the river. “A **permissive** rule and a **corrupt** reading have the same effect on a sample,” the analyst said. “The difference is who signs it.” Her **willpower** had carried the survey through a **coarse** season, and the group had not noticed.

The **reproductive** data and the urbanisation figures arrived on the same morning. “We urbanise a district and we call it growth,” the planner said. “To **urbanize** is not the same as to improve.” The **hesitation** in the room was honest, and it was the first useful signal of the whole arc.

The **insanity** of the summer had been the attempt to do both jobs, and the healthy response was to let one of them go. “A **fire** in the building would not require less of us,” the director said. “It would require the same people, now, with a **true** answer.” It was a **pleasant fortune**, and it did not appear by accident. We had to guess how the production of a survey could fill the role of a job, and we could avoid the fall only by refusing to sell the **museum's** data. A sincere sorry would not do; a quiet **defiance** would.

中文翻译

他们已经公布了每一份豁免，却仍然失去了那间屋子；如今剩下的唯一问题是，他们各自会选择什么。第十段弧线开始于一座城市历史博物馆，在那里，职业的选择似乎需要一份没人写过的评估。“出生在村庄和在城市获得学位，并不会产生同样的意识，”主管说，“你有一份稳定的履历和一个至高的名声，现在你必须决定它是为了什么。”

这个困境既有礼貌又凶猛。“我感激这份邀约，”林伟说，“但一个优雅的头衔不等于正直。”一位潜在的雇主寄来一份备忘录和一份关于工厂现代化的备忘文件；第二封信在同一口气里提到了它的另一种拼法；第三封信问的是在一场工厂已经输掉的争议中的中立。

野生动物调查提醒了他们真正拥有什么：一份尚可的数据集、一份可疑的预报，以及一座垂死的气象站。“要翻转这个裁决，需要一份果断的报告，”曼雅写道，“我们可以模仿一个体面的流程，却无法伪造它背后的毅力。”

第二周的难题是河流的酸性。“一条纵容的规则和一次腐败的读法，对样本产生同样的影响，”分析师说，“区别在于谁签的字。”她的意志力让这项调查撑过了一个粗糙的季节，而小组没有注意到。

生殖数据与城市化数字在同一个早上到来。“我们把一个区都市化，然后称之为增长，”规划者说，“使都市化不等于改善。”屋里那份犹豫是诚实的，而它是整段弧线第一个有用的信号。

这个夏天的荒唐之处在于想同时做两份工作，而健康的回应是放掉其中一份。“楼里着火不会要求我们更少，”主管说，“它要求同样这些人，在此时此刻，给出一个真实的答案。”这是一份令人愉快的运气，而它不是偶然出现的。我们必须猜测，一份调查的生产如何才能填满一份工作的角色，而只有拒绝出售博物馆的数据，我们才能避开那次跌落。一句真诚的道歉没有用；一次安静的蔑视才有用。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
seem si:m POS: v	vi. 象是, 似乎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. appear to exist; v. appear to one's own mind or opinion
choice tʃɔɪs POS: n	n. 选择, 精选品, 选择权; a. 精选的, 挑三拣四的, 上等的; [计] DOS内部命令:在批处理文件中; 该命令用于提示用户作出选择, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the person or thing chosen or selected; n. the act of choosing or selecting; s. of superior grade; s. appeal...
museum mju:ˈziəm POS: n	n. 博物馆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a depository for collecting and displaying objects having scientific or historical or artistic value
assessment əˈsesmənt POS: n	n. 评估, 估定, 评定的款额; [化] 评估 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an amount determined as payable; n. the market value set on assets
birth bɜ:θ POS: n	n. 出生, 起源; [医] 生产, 分娩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time when something begins (especially life); n. the event of being born; n. a baby born; an offspring
urban ˈɜ:ben POS: a	a. 都市的, 住在都市的, 习惯于都市的; [法] 城市的, 都市的, 市区的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or concerned with a city or densely populated area; a. located in or characteristic of a city or...
supreme sjuˈpri:m POS: n	n. 至高, 霸权; a. 至高的, 终级的, 极端的, 最大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. final or last in your life or progress; s. highest in excellence or achievement; s. greatest or maximal in d...
appreciate əˈpri:ʃieɪt POS: vt	vt. 赏识, 鉴别, 为...而感激, 领会, 欣赏; vi. 增值, 涨价 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. recognize with gratitude; be grateful for; v. be fully aware of; realize fully; v. gain in value; v. increase...
fortune ˈfɔ:tʃən POS: n	n. 财富, 运气, 兴隆, 大量财产, 好运, 命运; [法] 命运, 财产, 大量财产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large amount of wealth or prosperity; n. your overall circumstances or condition in life (including every...
pleasant ˈpleznt POS: a	a. 愉快的, 可爱的, 活泼的, 亲切的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. affording pleasure; being in harmony with your taste or likings; s. (of persons) having pleasing manners or...
steady ˈstedi POS: a	a. 稳定的, 不动摇的, 沉着, 稳固的, 坚定的, 经常的; vt. 使稳定, 使坚定; vi. 变为沉着, 稳固 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make steady; a. not subject to change or variation especially in behavior; s. securely in position; not shak...
consciousness ˈkɒnʃəsnɪs POS: n	n. 意识, 知觉, 自觉; [医] (有)意识, 清醒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an alert cognitive state in which you are aware of yourself and your situation
integrity ɪnˈtegrɪti POS: n	n. 正直, 廉正, 完整; [计] 完整性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an undivided or unbroken completeness or totality with nothing wanting; n. moral soundness
wildlife ˈwaɪldlaɪf POS: n	n. 野生动植物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. all living things (except people) that are undomesticated
decent ˈdi:snt POS: a	a. 有分寸的, 得体的, 大方的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. socially or conventionally correct; refined or virtuous; a. conforming to conventions of sexual behavior; s. ...
elegant ˈeleɡnt POS: a	a. 优雅的, 端庄的, 高雅的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. refined and tasteful in appearance or behavior or style; s. suggesting taste, ease, and wealth; s. displayin...
fierce fɪəs POS: a	a. 凶猛的, 猛烈的, 热烈的, 暴躁的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. marked by extreme intensity of emotions or convictions; inclined to react violently; fervid
dilemma dɪˈlemə POS: n	n. 困境, (进退两难的) 窘境 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. state of uncertainty or perplexity especially as requiring a choice between equally unfavorable options
puzzle ˈpʌzl POS: n	n. 难题, 迷惑; vt. 使困惑, 使为难; vi. 迷惑, 苦思 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particularly baffling problem that is said to have a correct solution; n. a game that tests your ingenuity...
reminder rɪˈmaɪndə POS: n	n. 提醒的人, 暗示; [经] 催单 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a message that helps you remember something; n. an experience that causes you to remember something
dying ˈdaɪɪŋ POS: a	a. 垂死的; [法] 快要死的, 垂死的, 临终的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. in or associated with the process of passing from life or ceasing to be

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
doubtful 'daʊtful POS: a	a. 可疑的, 疑心的, 不明确的; [法] 怀疑的, 有疑问的, 未确的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. open to doubt or suspicion; s. fraught with uncertainty or doubt; s. unsettled in mind or opinion
prospective pres'pektiv POS: a	a. 预期的, 将来的; [经] 预期的, 未来的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or concerned with or related to the future
respectable ri'spektəbl POS: a	a. 值得尊重的, 人格高尚的, 相当数量的; n. 品格高尚的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by socially or conventionally acceptable morals
decisive di'saisiv POS: a	a. 决定性的, 坚定的, 果断的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. determining or having the power to determine an outcome; s. unmistakable; a. characterized by decision and f...
polite pe'laɪt POS: a	a. 有礼貌的, 文雅的, 客气的, 有教养的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. showing regard for others in manners, speech, behavior, etc.
memo 'meməʊ POS: n	n. 备忘录; [经] 备忘录 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written proposal or reminder
memorandum 'memə'rændəm POS: n	n. 备忘录, 外交备忘录, 交易备忘录; [经] 备忘录, 便笺, 便函 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written proposal or reminder
corrupt kə'rʌpt POS: a	a. 腐败的, 贪污的, 讹误充斥的; vt. 使腐烂, 腐蚀, 使恶化; vi. 腐烂, 堕落 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. corrupt morally or by intemperance or sensuality; v. alter from the original; a. lacking in integrity; s. con...
reproductive 'ri:prə'dʌktiv POS: a	a. 生殖的, 再生的, 复制的; [医] 生殖的, 复现的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. producing new life or offspring
imitate 'imiteɪt POS: vt	vt. 模仿, 效法, 冒充, 仿造 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. reproduce someone's behavior or looks; v. appear like, as in behavior or appearance; v. make a reproduction...
hesitation 'hezɪ'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 犹豫, 踌躇, 含糊, 口吃, 暂停; [计] 暂停 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. indecision in speech or action; n. the act of pausing uncertainly
coarse kɔ:s POS: a	a. 粗糙的, 下等的, 粗俗的; [计] 粗略的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of textures that are rough to the touch or substances consisting of relatively large particles; s. lacking...
reversal ri've:sl POS: n	n. 翻转, 颠倒, 反转; [医] 逆转, 颠倒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a change from one state to the opposite state; n. turning in an opposite direction or position; n. a decisio...
modernization 'mɒdənaɪ'zeɪʃən POS: n	n. 现代化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. making modern in appearance or behavior; n. a modernized version (as of a play)
neutrality nju:'træliɪti POS: n	n. 中立, 不偏不倚, 中间状态; [医] 中性; 无作用[性] Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. nonparticipation in a dispute or war; n. pH value of 7
defiance di'faɪəns POS: n	n. 蔑视, 挑战; [法] 挑战, 藐视, 违抗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. intentionally contemptuous behavior or attitude; n. a hostile challenge; n. a defiant act
insanity in'sæniɪti POS: n	n. 疯狂, 愚顽, 精神错乱; [医] 精神病 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. relatively permanent disorder of the mind
modernisation 'mɒdənaɪ'zeɪʃən;-ni'z- POS: n	n. <主英>=modernization Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. making modern in appearance or behavior
acidity ə'sɪdɪti POS: n	n. 酸性; [化] 酸度; 酸性; 酸性反应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the taste experience when something acidic is taken into the mouth; n. pH values below 7
perseverance pə:'si:vɪərəns POS: n	n. 毅力, 忍耐, 锲而不舍, 不屈不挠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of persisting or persevering; continuing or repeating behavior
permissive pə'misɪv POS: a	a. 许可的, 获准的, 宽容的, 放任的, 放纵的, 允许选择的, 自由的; [法] 表示许可的, 随意的, 纵容的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not preventive; a. granting or inclined or able to grant permission; not strict in discipline
willpower 'wɪlpəʊ POS: n	n. 毅力, 意志力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the trait of resolutely controlling your own behavior
urbanize 'ə:bənaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使都市化, 使成都市式, 使文雅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make more industrial or city-like; v. impart urban habits, ways of life, or responsibilities upon